Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, May 16, 2022

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Present:	Mayor	S. Collier (entered at 7:07 p.m.)
		M. Crawford
		J. Dies
		S. Lee
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Deputy Mayor Lee called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of April 19, 2022;
- Special Meeting of April 29, 2022; and
- Closed Session Meeting of April 29, 2022

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Deputy Mayor Lee noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Sarah Moore, Acting Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

5. Delegations and Presentations

5.1 Delegation & Proclamation: Hidradenitis Awareness Week

Latoya Palmer, Founder of Hidradenitis & Me Support Group, noted that Hidradenitis Suppurativa is a chronic skin disease affecting 4% of Canadians. L. Palmer further noted that the purpose of Hidradenitis Awareness Week is to raise awareness and educate the public.

Deputy Mayor Lee presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed June 6 -12, 2022 as Hidradenitis Suppurativa Awareness Week in the Town of Ajax.

5.2 Delegation & Proclamation: Jewish Heritage Month in Ajax

William Barclay, B'nai Brith, discussed antisemitism statistics in Canada, the importance of irradicating and excise of antisemitism from within Canadian society, public education, and contributions from Canada's Jewish community.

Deputy Mayor Lee presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed May 2022 as Jewish Heritage Month in the Town of Ajax.

5.3 **Delegation & Proclamation: Neurofibromatosis Awareness**

In the absence of presenters Neveah Sosa and Nicole Goudreau, Neurofibromatosis Ontario, the proclamation certificate will be forwarded to the organization.

5.4 **Delegation & Proclamation: Pride Durham**

In the absence of presenter Caitlyn Causey, President, Pride Durham, the proclamation certificate will be forwarded to the organization.

5.5 **Delegation & Proclamation: Aging Well Month**

Moninder Nahar, Community Recreation Supervisor - Senior Programs & Services, noted that June marks the 38th anniversary of Seniors Month in Ontario, coined Aging Well Month, and discussed programs and services offered to seniors by the Town. M. Nahar introduced Linda Hodgins-Woods, Member of Town of Ajax Older Adult Task Force, who reviewed upcoming virtual and in-person events for the month of June, including the annual Seniors Barbecue. L. Hodgins-Woods introduced Elaine Lievaart, Community Engagement Associate – Ajax Public Library, who reviewed the Ajax Seniors Centre Without Walls schedule for the month of June. E. Lievaart introduced Joyce Starkman, Member of Town of Ajax Older Adult Task Force, and the recipient of the Ajax Senior of the Year Award. J. Starkman reviewed upcoming events and activities at the Ajax Public Library for the month of June. M. Nahar requested that Ajax Council proclaim June, 2022 as Aging Well Month in the Town of Ajax.

Deputy Mayor Lee vacated the Chair. Mayor Collier assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed June 2022 as Aging Well Month in the Town of Ajax.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence item 6.2 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.3, 6.4, 6.5, 6.6, 6.7, 6.8, 6.9, 6.10, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.14, 6.15, 6.16, 6.17, 6.18, 6.19, 6.20 and 6.21) dated May 16, 2022 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Lee assumed the Chair.

Item 6.2

Council Members discussed preferred community area land need scenarios submitted by Durham area municipalities, intensification, environmental assessment, conformity with the Growth Plan of Ontario, and the climate and housing emergency. Council Members expressed support for the recommendation endorsed by the Region of Durham.

Council Members sought clarification regarding the growth management scenario endorsed by the Region of Durham. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to the question from Council Members, noting that the Region endorsed community area land need scenario no. 4.

Council Members asked how Members voted at the Region's Planning & Economic Development Committee meeting. Regional Councillor Lee and Mayor Collier responded to the question.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Item 6.2 (The Regional Municipality of Durham – Envision Durham – Growth Management Study Land Need Assessment - Staff Recommendation on a Land Need Scenario) of the Correspondence Report be received for information.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

7. Reports

7.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.2.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, May 2, 2022

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated May 2, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2. General Government Committee Report

7.2.2 General Government Committee, May 9, 2022

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the General Government Committee Report dated May 9, 2022, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated May 16, 2022, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

None

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Council Members discussed increased costs and funding associated with the Beaverton Supporting Housing project, the implementation of a clear garbage bag pilot program in the Municipality of Clarington, Vision Zero statistics, and Durham Region's cybersecurity strategy and cybersecurity insurance coverage. Mayor Collier noted that Durham Region Transit has extended the Y10 monthly pass program.

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Council Members asked questions regarding rationale for the loss of cybersecurity insurance at the Region and the status of the Town's cybersecurity insurance coverage. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of May 16, 2022 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Vacant Home Tax

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions regarding strategies to identify a home's occupancy status. D. Valentim responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS the dramatic increase to housing costs in Ontario due, in part, to high demand and low supply may be exacerbated by homes sitting vacant;

AND WHEREAS to lead to a reduction in vacant homes, Part IX.1 Optional Tax on Vacant Residential Units, of the Municipal Act, 2001 provides interested municipalities with the option to seek designation status from the Minister of Finance to be granted the authority to impose a tax on vacant residential units in certain circumstances;

AND WHEREAS other municipalities, including the City of Toronto, City of Ottawa, and Region of Halton have approved the development and implementation of a vacant homes tax;

AND WHEREAS Ajax Council wishes to protect the availability and affordability of housing in Ajax, and reduce the negative impacts of vacant homes on Ajax residents;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council support the review of a vacant homes tax by Durham Region; and

2. This motion be circulated to the Regional Municipality of Durham and lower-tier municipalities in Durham Region.

CARRIED

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended to allow the introduction of a motion without notice:

- Homelessness Training for Ajax Council

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

9.2 **Homelessness Training for Ajax Council**

Councillor Bower and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions regarding scheduling and availability of staff and Council Members. N. Cooper responded to the question from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

WHEREAS there has been a significant increase in the number of individuals experiencing homelessness in Durham Region;

AND WHEREAS according to the Community Development Council Durham's latest Point-in-Time Count, conducted in October 2021, Ajax had the second highest concentration of homeless individuals behind Oshawa, with 100 of the 573 homeless individuals counted being in Ajax;

AND WHEREAS Ajax Council has put an emphasis on education, participating in Anti-Racism and Diversity training sessions this term, with a focus on expanding their understanding of diversity, equity, and inclusion issues, such as unconscious bias, anti-Black racism, anti-racism, gender diversity and inclusivity, and accessibility training;

AND WHEREAS homelessness training would complement the training already received and help provide members of Ajax Council with better understanding of the vulnerable sector, the services currently available, and the support gaps;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

Staff be directed to schedule a homelessness training session for members of Ajax Council with the Christian Faith Outreach Centre Ajax Hub by July 15, 2022.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 33-2022 to 38-2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Lee noted that he and Councillor Khan will be bringing forward a motion to the June meeting of Council regarding standard procedures for traffic calming reporting.

Mayor Collier noted that he and Regional Councillor Lee will be bringing forward a motion to the June meeting of Council regarding a feasibility study for an E-scooter program.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including a virtual community Ward 1 meeting on May 18, 2022, the retirement of Teresa McNicol, Firefighter, the unveiling of the Haskell crosswalk on May 24, 2022, Ribfest from June 3-5, 2022 at Ajax Downs, the Guyana flag raising at Heritage Square on May 26, 2022, and Live with Mayor Collier on Tuesday, May 31, 2022.

Council Members thanked the Hindu Federation and Sankat Mochan Hanuman Mandir & Cultural Centre for the community tree planting event along the Ajax waterfront held on May 14, 2022.

Council Members expressed sympathy for the victims of the tragic shooting in Buffalo, New York on May 14, 2022.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 39-2022 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on May 16, 2022, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the May 16, 2022 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (8:11 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk